

ANSER IT TEAM TRAINING

Meet Microsoft 365 Copilot in GCC High

Day 2: The authoring apps and the art of the possible.

Friday, October 2, 2026 · 9:00 AM to 1:00 PM Eastern

Instructor: Allen Sanders, MCT, NetCom Learning



Today we author deliverables

01 Word: An informed project recommendation

Document summarization, multi-source synthesis, rewrite tools, and recommendation assembly.

02 Excel: Insights and formulas

Table formatting prerequisites, natural language formulas, PivotTables, and prompt-driven verification.

03 PowerPoint: A briefing deck

Starting from the organizational template, converting documents into slides, and refining presentation structure.

04 Art of the possible, flex block, and wrap

GCC High service boundaries, Purview controls, Pages, Notebooks, and personal 30-day action plans.

Includes two planned 10-minute breaks between application modules.

RECAP

Day 1 gave us the foundation

Three core principles carry directly into today's authoring workflows.

DATA BOUNDARY

Sovereign boundary

Prompts, context, and responses remain strictly inside the Microsoft 365 GCC High service boundary. Tenant data is never used to train foundational models.

PROMPT FRAMEWORK

GCSE structure

Every effective prompt anchors on four pillars: Goal, Context, Source, and Expectations. Strong framing produces reliable first drafts.

OPERATING MODEL

Human in the loop

Copilot drafts, but a human reviews, validates, and refines before anything enters production or is shared with stakeholders.

05

APPLICATION WORKSHOP

Module 5: Copilot in Word

Summarizing complex documents, cross-referencing source files, and drafting structured decision documents in GCC High.

DOCUMENT INVESTIGATION

Summarize and question a document without reading it end to end

- Ask for an executive summary of a document, highlighting key findings, timelines, and decision points.
- Query specific sections, appendices, or policy requirements using targeted follow-up prompts.
- Reference external files stored in OneDrive or SharePoint directly in the prompt window for cross-document analysis.

Copilot extracts source references with clickable citations back to original paragraphs.



SYNTHESIS WORKFLOW

Fuse several documents into one recommendation

Follow this structured four-stage process to combine requirements and technical options into an actionable documented plan.

1

Gather sources

Reference the baseline project requirements document and each competing technical approach.

2

Map criteria

Instruct Copilot to evaluate each proposed approach against explicit mandatory criteria.

3

Draft matrix

Generate a structured scoring table with a clear narrative rationale for the top option.

4

Validate

Verify technical assertions, check citations, and edit the final tone before publishing.

EDITING TOOLS

Rewrite, adjust tone, generate from selected text

- Point Copilot at a paragraph or section and ask for a rewrite or draft alternatives.
- Modify tone and density using targeted instructions such as more concise, more formal, or formatted as a list.
- Generate supplemental explanations or an executive summary from existing text, then insert what you want to keep.
- Check every factual assertion and metric against the source documentation before distributing.



HANDS-ON PRACTICE · 25 MINUTES

Lab: build the project recommendation

Use the provided synthetic course files to draft and refine a complete decision briefing in Word.

STEP 1 · PRIMARY PROMPT

Draft using GCSE

Write comprehensive GCSE prompts to compare and evaluate proposed reference implementations against a defined specification. Direct Copilot to evaluate options against project requirements and output a recommendation.

STEP 2 · REFINEMENT

Refine and review

Issue targeted follow-up prompts. Verify all factual references against the source documents.

06

APPLICATION WORKSHOP

Module 6: Copilot in Excel

Working with structured data tables, generating formulas, building PivotTables, and validating computational outputs.

DATA PREPARATION

Copilot works best on a formatted table

- Format source data as an Excel table with clear, single-row column headers.
- Ask about trends, outliers, and key drivers in plain language.
- Know the scope: the Copilot Chat pane works from the open workbook plus any files you reference. In GCC High, analysis of structured data is limited until Edit with Copilot in Excel arrives.
- Avoid merged cells, blank header rows, and embedded subtotals that break the table structure.



From plain-language request to chart, PivotTable, and formula

In GCC High today, Copilot Chat in Excel advises and drafts. You apply the change to the workbook.

1

Visualizations

Generate recommended bar charts, trend lines, or breakdown charts, then insert them onto new or active sheets.

2

PivotTables

Ask for the row, column, and value layout that answers a question such as spend by department, then build the PivotTable yourself.

3

Formulas

Ask Copilot to write the formula for a new column, or to explain existing nested logic in plain English. Paste it in, then verify it.

Editing in place is not yet available in GCC High, but Copilot can provide step-by-step instructions walking a user through how to manually implement.

Verify what Copilot builds

Computational accuracy in government environments requires strict verification rituals.

Check Area	Verification Practice	Watch For
Formulas	Spot-check formula logic and results by hand against three to five sample rows.	Relative versus absolute cell references once the formula is filled down a column.
Charts	Confirm the chart uses the intended data range, series labels, and axis categories.	Total or summary rows pulled into a series, which skew the scale.
Insights	Cross-check summarized metrics against table sums or standard count functions.	In GCC High, Copilot's structured-data analysis is limited for now. Recompute any number you plan to reuse.

Read the formula in the formula bar before you fill it down a production sheet. Analyze Data on the Data tab is arriving in GCC High (roadmap ID 488142, September 2026 target). Check your tenant.

HANDS-ON PRACTICE · 25 MINUTES

Lab: insights, formulas, and a chart

Work with the synthetic IT service ticket dataset to test Copilot's analytical capabilities.

01	02	03	04
Format table	Query insights	Add formulas	Build visual
Convert the raw range into an official Excel table and verify single-row header names.	Prompt Copilot to surface three operational insights regarding ticket volume and resolution.	Insert a calculated response-time column, then ask Copilot to explain an existing formula.	Generate a PivotTable and matching bar chart by prompt, then verify the underlying data range.

07

APPLICATION WORKSHOP

Module 7: Copilot in PowerPoint

Building on organizational templates, transforming narrative documents into slide decks, and refining presentation flow.

PRESENTATION SETUP

Start from the organizational template

- Open the approved organizational template first so all generated slides inherit official typography, logos, and color palettes.
- Generate a complete slide deck draft from a plain-language concept using the GCSE prompt framework.
- Create presentations directly from an existing Word document by referencing the OneDrive or SharePoint URL.
- Allow Copilot to draft speaker notes automatically to support slide talk tracks.



Refine the deck with Copilot



1. Summarize the deck
2. Add a slide on a topic
3. Ask questions about the presentation
4. Review every slide before presenting

HANDS-ON PRACTICE · 25 MINUTES

Lab: turn the memo into a briefing

Convert your Word recommendation memo from Module 5 into an executive slide deck.

PHASE 1 · GENERATION

Draft from document

Launch the approved template, prompt Copilot to generate a presentation referencing your saved recommendation memo, and observe how document sections map onto individual slide layouts.

PHASE 2 · ITERATION

Refine and question

Add a dedicated slide on implementation timelines. Prompt Copilot to summarize the key points of the presentation, then pose two technical questions to test how thoroughly the deck addresses project risks.

08

ROADMAP & CAPABILITIES

Module 8: The Art of the Possible

Commercial feature demonstrations, GCC High service limits, administrative governance, and roadmap tracking.

Check availability before you promise a feature

Copilot capability	GCC High status
Copilot Chat in Word, Excel, PowerPoint, and OneNote	Available (Excel structured-data analysis limited)
Edit with Copilot in Word, Excel, PowerPoint, and OneNote	Not currently available. Roadmap: PowerPoint 566701 (September 2026), Word 570277 (October 2026)
Word, Excel, and PowerPoint Agents	Not currently available
Copilot in Teams (chat, channel, meetings)	Not currently available. Roadmap targets October 2026
Copilot in SharePoint and SharePoint agents	Not currently available
Pages, Notebooks, Prompt Gallery, Researcher, Analyst	Available
Copilot Analytics in Viva Insights	Not currently available. Roadmap targets September 2026

Source: Microsoft Copilot service description on Microsoft Learn, last updated August 5, 2026. Roadmap dates are targets, not commitments.

COMMERCIAL DEMO

What commercial tenants see today

- SharePoint authoring: Copilot assists in drafting pages, structuring team sites, querying document libraries, and building customized agents scoped to specific repositories.
- Power BI integration: Copilot reasons across enterprise report models, generates narrative summaries, and drafts DAX calculations on commercial tenants.
- Edit with Copilot: Copilot changes the document, workbook, or deck directly instead of answering in the chat pane.
- Copilot Cowork is now on the roadmap for GCC and GCC High (ID 571637, November 2026 target).



ADMINISTRATION

Controls the IT team can use in GCC High

- Microsoft Purview controls for Copilot and Copilot Chat are available in GCC High. They require Purview licensing, included with Microsoft 365 G3 and G5 or bought standalone.
- Sensitivity labels, audit logging, eDiscovery, and data loss prevention policies apply to Copilot interactions.
- Not available in GCC High as of the August 5, 2026 service description: Insider Risk Management, and Copilot Analytics in Viva Insights. Copilot Analytics has a September 2026 roadmap target, so check your tenant.
- Security Copilot is a separate product and is not offered in US government clouds.



Track every feature on the Microsoft 365 Roadmap

Follow four simple steps to stay ahead of upcoming GCC High releases.

01	02	03	04
Open roadmap	Filter cloud	Search feature	Verify status
Navigate to the public Microsoft 365 Roadmap portal.	Select Cloud Instance and choose GCC High specifically.	Enter the app or capability name to view current release phases.	Cross-reference the service description, then watch Message center for your tenant's rollout notice.

COLLABORATION TOOLS

Flex block: Pages, Notebooks, and Prompt Gallery

Three powerful capabilities currently available in GCC High environments.

COPILOT PAGES

Dynamic collaboration

Turn any Copilot Chat response into a shared, persistent, multi-user editable page side by side with active prompts.

COPILOT NOTEBOOKS

Multi-source reasoning

Gather project specifications, approaches, and notes into an extended scratchpad to query across all files simultaneously.

PROMPT GALLERY

Reusable prompts

Save and catalog your highest-performing GCSE prompts, and browse team prompts organized by application and task.

All three capabilities operate strictly within your existing GCC High tenant boundary.

NEXT STEPS

Your personal 30-day plan

Translate course concepts into daily operational habits.

- Pick one application and one recurring weekly task to draft with Copilot.
- Continue learning via Microsoft Learn training paths, Prompt Gallery examples, and the GCC High roadmap.
- Complete the course evaluation survey to share your feedback.

Thank you, ANSER IT Team! · netcomlearning.com

